



Select top-quality vegetables, harvest when cool if possible, and wash and sort them under cool running water to remove dirt and damaged pieces.

STEP

1

Freezing Vegetables



Peel, trim, and cut vegetables into pieces as directed for freezing; remove any damaged parts.

STEP

2

Freezing Vegetables



Heat a large amount of water to a rolling boil or prepare steam with at least 1-2 inches of boiling water in a kettle with a tight-fitting lid.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

3

Freezing Vegetables



Put vegetables in a wire basket or steamer basket; for boiling water blanching, start timing when the water returns to boiling; for steam blanching, start timing when lid is on.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

4

Freezing Vegetables



Immediately cool blanched vegetables in ice water for the same amount of time as blanching to stop cooking.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

5

Freezing Vegetables



Drain cooled vegetables thoroughly and pat dry to remove surface moisture before packaging.

STEP

6

Freezing Vegetables



Pack blanched and dried vegetables into moisture- and vapor-resistant freezer bags or containers, leaving appropriate headspace according to the vegetable type (usually 1/2 inch or none).

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

7

Freezing Vegetables



Remove excess air from packages/bags and seal tightly to prevent freezer burn and moisture loss.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

8

Freezing Vegetables



Freeze packaged vegetables promptly at 0 deg F (-18 deg C) or below for best quality and safety.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

9

Freezing Vegetables



Mark packages with content and freezing date to ensure proper rotation and use within recommended storage times.

STEP

10

Freezing Vegetables



To prepare, cook frozen vegetables by submerging in boiling water (~1/2 cup per pint), cover, simmer until tender; leafy greens and corn on the cob should be partially thawed before cooking.

! SAFETY STEP

STEP

11

Freezing Vegetables